

**CONFIDENTIAL**



# POWER, POLITICS, AND PERCEPTION

A Masterclass in Metaphor,  
Idioms, and Critical Reading.



**LEVEL: ADVANCED (B2-C2)**



# INTELLIGENCE DIRECTIVES



## 1. Decipher Major Headlines

Establish the core facts behind two global news events.



## 2. Unlock Power Vocabulary

Extract and define advanced idioms and phrasal verbs in context.



## 3. Decode Metaphors

Analyze the figurative language used in art and political journalism.



## 4. Synthesize & Apply

Connect these abstract concepts to real-world scenarios through active discussion.

CONFIDENTIAL



# BRIEFING FILE 01: THE WATERLOO PLACE INCIDENT

## THE ACTION

Statue installed covertly in the early hours of Wednesday; confirmed by Banksy via Instagram.

## THE VISUAL

A suited man stepping off a plinth, his face completely obscured by a flag.



## THE LOCATION

Waterloo Place, St James's - a central London area historically designed to celebrate imperialism and military dominance.

Every Banksy piece is a campaign.



# BRIEFING FILE 02: THE APPEASEMENT TRAP

## STEP 1: THE STRATEGY

German Chancellor  
Merz spends a year  
trying to mollify  
the US President.

## STEP 2: THE SLIGHT

Merz criticizes  
the US  
administration's  
lack of an exit  
plan for Iran.

## STEP 3: THE RETALIATION

The US President  
imposes a 25%  
tariff on EU  
vehicles and  
orders the  
withdrawal of  
5,000 troops from  
Germany.

## STEP 4: THE LESSON

Months of  
diplomatic efforts  
are ruined  
instantly,  
proving  
appeasement fails  
against erratic  
leadership.

CONFIDENTIAL



# FACT-CHECK PROTOCOL

|                        |                                                                                 |                                                              |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| [ T ] <del>[ F ]</del> | Banksy's new statue celebrates British military dominance.                      | It critiques blind patriotism and extreme nationalism.       |
| [ T ] <del>[ F ]</del> | German Chancellor Merz successfully avoided US tariffs by remaining quiet.      | He criticized the US, leading to 25% tariffs.                |
| [ T ] <del>[ F ]</del> | US Lawmakers generally agree with the decision to withdraw troops from Germany. | Republican chairmen said it undermines US security.          |
| <del>[ T ]</del> [ F ] | Banksy's installation was temporary and placed without official permission.     | Installed covertly; contractors later added safety barriers. |



# THE LANGUAGE OF ACTION

...Banksy had pulled off another fantastic coup...



**Pull off (v.)** To successfully execute something difficult, unexpected, or covert.

We've got to face up to the fact that Britain has an imperialistic history...



**Face up to (v.)** To accept and deal with a difficult reality or problem.

Germany has stepped up in response to calls for greater burden sharing...



**Step up (v.)** To take on more responsibility; to rise to a challenge.

FIELD TEST:

Fill in the blank: The activist finally \_\_\_\_\_ the reality that her protest wasn't working.

(Answer: faced up to)



# THE VOCABULARY OF INFLUENCE

## SUBSERVIENCE

(Yielding to Power)



Kowtow: To act in an excessively obedient manner.

Sucking up to: Flattering someone in authority for personal gain.

All for naught: Completely wasted effort; coming to nothing.

## RESISTANCE

(Claiming Power)



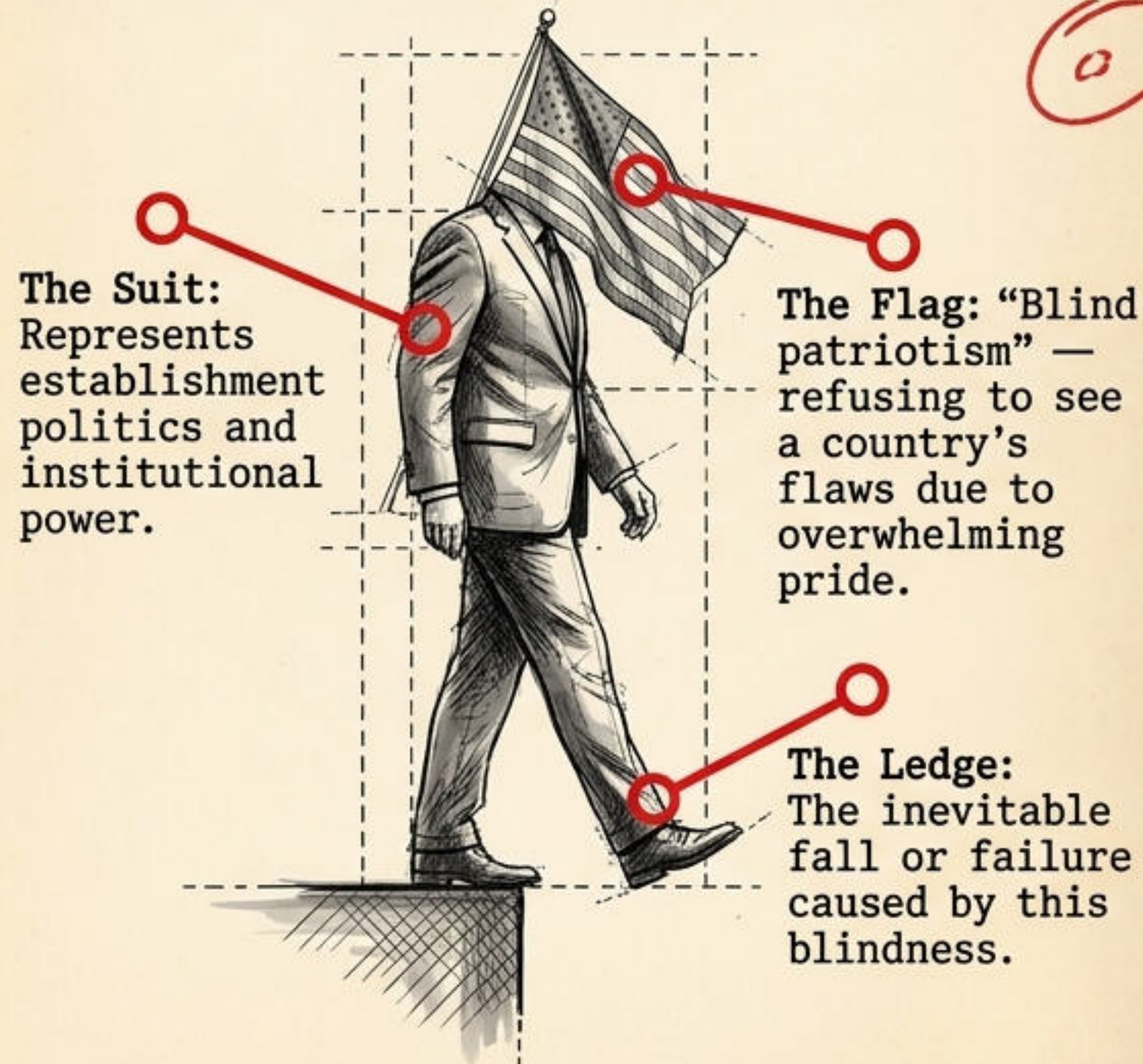
Show some spine: To display courage and stand up for oneself.

Knockout: Exceptionally impressive or effective.



# DECODING THE METAPHOR

## TEXT 1: BLIND PATRIOTISM



## TEXT 2: THE MOB BOSS

**Concept:** A simile stating the president "governs like a mob boss."

**Fear:** Ruling through intimidation rather than diplomacy.

**Protection:** Treating alliances as transactional, paying for safety.

**CYCLE OF EXTORTION**

**Retaliation:** Punishing allies (tariffs, troop withdrawals) for minor slights.



# CHARACTER DYNAMICS MATRIX

|                                                                                                       |  <b>THE REBEL</b> |  <b>THE APPEASER</b> |  <b>THE STRONGMAN</b> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>PRIMARY GOAL</b> | Critique extreme nationalism.                                                                       | Maintain transatlantic harmony.                                                                         | Force subservience and extract leverage.                                                                 |
| <b>CHOSEN TACTIC</b>                                                                                  | Covert, highly visible public art.                                                                  | Months of diplomatic 'sucking up'.                                                                      | Vengeance, tariffs, military ultimatums.                                                                 |
| <b>DIAGNOSTIC ADJECTIVES</b>                                                                          | Subversive,<br>Brutally Simple.                                                                     | Vulnerable,<br>Subservient.                                                                             | Erratic,<br>Thin-skinned,<br>Bumptious.                                                                  |



# SYNTHESIS: THE COST OF BLIND ALLEGIANCE

## THE ART WARNING

Waterloo Place.

A suited man  
blinded by his own  
flag is about to  
walk off a ledge.

Unquestioning  
nationalism leads  
to a dangerous fall.

## THE GEOPOLITICAL REALITY

Transatlantic  
Politics.

A chancellor kowtows  
to an erratic leader  
and loses security  
anyway. Appeasing  
authoritarianism  
guarantees failure.

## THE CORE INSIGHT

Both texts demonstrate  
that giving power to  
something you refuse  
to clearly see  
always results in a  
steep drop.



# THE INTERROGATION ROOM



## 1. The Metaphor in You

Have you ever experienced a situation in your career or studies where you had to "**show some spine**" rather than "**kowtow**" to an intimidating personality?



## 2. Art vs. Reality

Banksy's statue is described as a "**knockout**" critique of "**blind patriotism**." Do you believe public art has the power to change how people view their country's history?



## 3. The Appeasement Trap

Based on Reading 2, why is it ultimately a "losing proposition" to try and **mollify** an erratic leader? Can you think of a historical or personal example where this proved true?



# CASE CLOSED: FINAL BRIEFING

**REQUIRES ACTION**



## ACTION ITEM 1: SUMMARIZE

In one complete sentence using the word “appease”, summarize the fatal political mistake made by the German Chancellor.

## ACTION ITEM 2: INTERPRET

Look back at the phrase “impossible to unsee.” Why did the art collector describe Banksy’s metaphor of the blinded man this way?

Dossier Filed By: \_\_\_\_\_